

Interrogation avoidance

One context-rich question beats five pressure questions.

Core move

Turn cross-examination into invitation: add context, ask one soft question, and give an easy way to pass.

Minimum viable phrase

I do not want this to feel like an interview. One small question, and you can skip it: what matters most here?

Use when

Curiosity, concern, or problem-solving could sound like pressure, blame, screening, or rapid-fire probing.

Repair

That came out like an interrogation. Let me slow down. You do not have to answer all that.